

B.A. in Music roadmap: four years

First-year entry, eight semesters · Music office: music@csueastbay.edu, (510) 885-3135



This roadmap
online

Degree	Entry	Total	Catalog
Bachelor of Arts in Music	First-year, fall A (even years)	120 units	2027–2028

01 Degree at a glance

Component	Units
Lower-division music	15
Upper-division music	18
Applied study and ensembles	9
Music electives	12
General education and graduation requirements	48
Free electives*	18
Total	120

*These vary depending on each student’s path through the GE requirements and free electives, up to 120 units.

02 Before the first semester

Applied lessons begin after an applied area placement, which is an audition on the student’s instrument or voice or a creative portfolio in composition or music production. Ensemble placement happens at the first meeting of each ensemble.

General education paths differ from student to student. The GE courses shown are one typical selection for music majors. Students build their own GE plan with an advisor.

String players take Chamber Orchestra (MUS 365) as their Major Performing Ensemble.

The Certificate in Music Education can be added to the B.A. Its roadmap shows where the certificate courses fall.

03 Semester by semester

☐ Music ☐ General education

Lower division

First semester (fall A)

Course	Title	Units
ENGL 100	College Writing: Stretch I	3
ENGL 109	College Writing Lab	1
ES 121	People’s History I	3
HIST 110	United States to 1877	3
MUS 108	The Language of Music	3
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study (applied area placement)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
Semester total		15

Second semester (spring A)

Course	Title	Units
ENGL 101	College Writing: Stretch II	2
ENGL 109	College Writing Lab	1
COMM 100	Oral Communication	3
MATH 118E	Mathematics for the Arts and Humanities	4
MUS 111	Music Theory I	2
MUS 115	Aural Skills I	1
MUS 118	Keyboard Musicianship I	1
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
Semester total		16

Third semester (fall B)

Course	Title	Units
PHIL 100	Critical Thinking	3
GE 3B	Humanities	3
GE 5A	Physical and Biological Sciences	3
MUS 112	Music Theory II	2
MUS 116	Aural Skills II	1
MUS 119	Keyboard Musicianship II	1
MUS 381	Essentials of Music Technology	3
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
Semester total		18

Upper division

Fifth semester (fall A)

Course	Title	Units
UD GE 4	Upper-division Social and Behavioral Sciences	3
MUS 323	Topics in Western Music History	3
MUS 312	Form and Analysis	3
MUS 461–469	Applied Music Study (jury)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Music electives	4
Semester total		15

Seventh semester (fall B)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 304	World Music & Culture	3
MUS 410	20th and 21st C Styles and Techniques	3
MUS 461–469	Applied Music Study (jury)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
MUS 360–369	Chamber Ensemble	1
	Free electives	3
Semester total		12

Fourth semester (spring B)

Course	Title	Units
GE 5B–C	Physical and Biological Sciences with lab	4
GE 6	Ethnic Studies	3
MUS 202	Writing About Music	3
MUS 211	Music Theory III	2
MUS 215	Aural Skills III	1
MUS 218	Keyboard Musicianship III	1
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
Semester total		16

Sixth semester (spring A)

Course	Title	Units
UD GE 5	Upper-division Science and Quantitative Reasoning	3
UWR	University Writing Requirement	3
MUS 324	History of American Music	3
MUS 461–469	Applied Music Study (jury)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Free electives	3
Semester total		14

Eighth semester (spring B)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 461–469	Applied Music Study (jury)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Free electives	12
Semester total		14

04 Music electives

Students choose 12 units. Up to 4 additional units of Applied Music Study, 4 additional units of Major Performing Ensembles, and 7 additional units of Chamber Ensembles also count toward electives.

Music education

MUS 331	Foundations of Music Education, 3
MUS 335	Technology for Music Educators, 3
MUS 431	Elementary Music Teaching Methods, 3
MUS 432	Instrumental Music Teaching Methods, 3
MUS 433	Choral Music Teaching Methods, 3
MUS 445	Piano Pedagogy, 2
MUS 446	Vocal Pedagogy, 2
MUS 495	Music Education Practicum, 1

MUS 497	Contemporary Issues in Music Education, 3
---------	---

Conducting

MUS 341	Basic Conducting, 3
MUS 441	Intermediate Conducting, 3

Composition and music production

MUS 280	Composers Workshop, 1
MUS 412	Contrapuntal Techniques, 3
MUS 414	Contemporary Orchestration and Arranging, 3
MUS 415	MIDI Orchestration, 3
MUS 485	Advanced Sound Design I: Sampling, Editing, and Mixing, 3

MUS 486	Advanced Sound Design II: Synthesis, Modulation & Creative Digital Signal Processing, 3
---------	---

History and global music

MUS 305	Global Hip-Hop, 3
MUS 326	Topics in Global Music, 3

Entrepreneurship and research

MUS 303	Entrepreneurship in the Arts, 3
MUS 490	Independent Study, 1–3
MUS 498	Internship, 1–3

Performance

MUS 317	Improvisation Techniques, 1
---------	-----------------------------